



CONTACT

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EDUCATION

MA Development Studies (Economics)

Oct. 2023 – Nov. 2025

University of Passau, Passau.

Final grade: Good (2.2), ranked in the top 25 per cent of the cohort.

Master's thesis: Climate variability and agricultural conditions in Senegal: a critical comparison of farmers' local weather perceptions and real weather data.

M.Sc. in Economic Analysis

Oct. 2020 – Feb. 2022

Universitat Oberta de Catalunya (UOC), Barcelona.

Final grade: Good (8.9/10), ranked in the top 20 per cent of the cohort.

Master's thesis: Analysis of the Dynamics and Structure of the Ecuadorian Labour Market during the Period 2007–2019.

B.Sc. Economics and Management

Oct. 2017 – Nov. 2018

University of Grenoble Alpes, France
Double degree.

Final grade: Assez Bien, ranked in the top 20 per cent of the cohort.

B.Sc. Economics

Oct. 2014 – March 2019

Pontifical Catholic University of Ecuador, Quito.

Final grade: Very Good (9.0/10), ranked in the top 19 per cent of the cohort.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Development economics
Climate and Environmental Economics
Migration
Agricultural Economics
Labour Economics
Statistical Quality

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2023–2025 DAAD Helmut Schmidt Programme, Public Policy and Good Governance, 10 out of 800 applications.

2020–2022 SENESCYT 'Common Globe' Scholarship.

2013–2014 Scholarship for Academic Excellence;

2014 Academic Honours High School: Ranked 3rd out of 100 graduating students.

Camila Isabel Aguirre Díaz

Development economics | Applied microeconomics | Causal Inference

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant – Department of Climate and Development Policy Jan 2026 – present
RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research, Essen – Germany

Research projects: Senegal Migration Panel

Empirical analysis of the effect of climate variability on migration in rural Senegal by linking panel data with high-resolution geospatial climate data.

Development and validation of climate shock indicators for 143 villages to enable an econometric analysis of the effects of so-called 'false starts' – prolonged dry spells following the first rains during the sowing season – on household migration.

Conducting robustness analyses using alternative definitions of climate shocks, precipitation datasets, model specifications and analysis samples to test the sensitivity of the estimates.

Creation of maps and visualisations of results in R and Stata to illustrate spatial patterns of climate exposure and migration.

Student assistant – Department of Climate and Development Policy Aug 2024 – Dec 2025

RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research, Essen – Germany

Research projects: Senegal Migration Panel

Contributed to the design and implementation of a panel survey involving 3,700 rural households, including questionnaire development, pilot testing, interviewer training and field monitoring.

Developed automated validation and data cleaning processes in Statistical Software, thereby reducing the manual cleaning workload and the error rate by around 70 per cent and improving data quality during fieldwork.

Validated and optimised over 800 questions across three survey instruments to improve measurement quality, questionnaire consistency and data quality.

Conducted independent research about subjectively perceived precipitation and objectively measured weather data as part of my Master's thesis.

Reviewed and classified 447 economic studies on topographical instrumental variables, as well as the creation of network visualisations for the RWI working paper A Slippery Slope: Topographic Variation as an Instrumental Variable.

Research Assistant – Economics and Business Management Mar 2018 – Jan 2019

Institute of Economic Research, Faculty of Economics and Business Management,

Quito – Ecuador

Research projects: Causes of the reproduction of inequalities in Ecuador

Review of empirical literature and analysis of extensive census microdata from Peru, Bolivia and Ecuador using quantitative methods to investigate socio-economic inequalities and intergenerational mobility.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Academic Coordinator and Lecturer in Mathematics

Apr 2019 – Apr 2020

Advanced Studies Centre (CEAV), Quito – Ecuador

Taught mathematics and statistics, preparing course materials, delivering structured lectures and assessing students' learning progress.

Teaching Assistant in Econometrics

Sept 2015 – Mar 2016

Pontifical Catholic University of Ecuador, Quito – Ecuador

Delivered Stata and R tutorials on cross-sectional, panel and time-series analysis; prepared exercise sheets and model solutions and held consultation hours.

PUBLICATIONS & RESEARCH PAPERS

Working Papers & Research Articles

Haveresch, Sievert & Sall (2026). False Starts, Fewer Departures: Early-Season Dry Spells and Migration in Rural Senegal. RWI Working Paper. Research contribution: Preparation of climate data and empirical analysis.

Haveresch, Ankel-Peters & Bensch (2025). A Slippery Slope: Topographic Variation as an Instrumental Variable. RWI Working Paper. Research contribution: Literature review and network visualisation.

Granda Benítez (2020). Land ownership as a mechanism for the reproduction of inequality in Ecuador from 1895 to the 1920s, Chapters, in: Guillaume Vallet (ed.), Inequalities and the Progressive Era, chapter 11, pages 145-157, Edward Elgar Publishing. Research contribution: Literature review

Granda Benítez (2017). The Influence of the Economic Crisis of the 1980s on Inequality of Opportunity in Primary and Secondary Education in Ecuador. PUCE. Research contribution: Analysis of census data and empirical analysis.

METHODS AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

Econometrics and quantitative empirical methods

Causal inference; panel data analysis; fixed-effects models; cross-sectional data analysis; time series and trend analysis; hypothesis testing; robustness and sensitivity analyses.

Data and Research

Preparation, validation and analysis of large datasets; household and census microdata; questionnaire design; panel surveys; field monitoring; automated data cleaning and quality assurance.

Climate and Geospatial Data

Earth observation and rasterised climate data; spatial data processing; creation and validation of environmental shock indicators.

Statistical Quality

UN-NQAF / ISO Quality Framework

Statistical software

Very good knowledge of: R, Stata, Power BI, SurveyCTO, SPSS.

Good knowledge of: Python, SQL, Google Earth Engine, GitHub, KoboToolbox.

LANGUAGES

Spanish — native language

English — C1

German — B2

French — B1

LANGUAGE TRAINING

Aug 2026 – Dec 2026 Berufssprachkurse. Berufliche Fortbildungszentren der Bayerischen Wirtschaft (bfz). Munich

Specialist publications

United Nations (2022). Guidelines on Quality Assurance Frameworks for Statistical Processes and Outputs. Technical contribution -Strategies section

National Institute of Statistics and Censuses of Ecuador (2020). Methodology of the national survey on family relationships and gender-based violence against women. Co-author.

SEMINARS

Global Attitudes to Science: Evidence from the TISP Many Labs Project and Implications for Climate Policy and Prosocial Behaviour, *RWI Environmental and Behavioural Economics Seminar- Participation* Sep 2026

Analysing the impact of climate change on economic growth in the SADC region: a synthetic control approach, *RWI Policy Lab Seminar- Participation* Apr 2026

Global food prices and migration in Sub-Saharan Africa, *Berlin Network Seminar* Jan 2026

Health Impacts of Transboundary Air Pollution: Evidence from the German-Polish Border, *RWI Policy Lab Seminar- Participation* Jan 2026

Health Behaviours: Health Shocks as Drivers of Persistent Change, *RWI Health Economics Seminar- Participation* May 2025

When Institutions Interact: How the Effects of Unemployment Insurance are Shaped by Retirement Policies, *RWI Labour Economics Seminar- Participation* Nov 2024

Promises of Circular Bioeconomy in the Global South? An Institutional Analysis of Costa Rica's Pineapple Value Chain, *University of Passau Conference- Participation* Aug 2024

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Statistical Analyst – Department of Statistical Quality May 2021 – Mar 2023

National Institute of Statistics and Censuses, Quito – Ecuador

Led an eight-person team in developing 200+ quality and performance indicators to monitor 33 national surveys, censuses, and administrative records under UN statistical quality standards.

Led quality certification and monitoring of national statistics on agriculture, employment, public revenue, health, and gender, applying national and UN quality frameworks to strengthen statistical reliability and compliance.

Represented INEC in UNSD and ECLAC technical working groups and contributed to the development of a regional UN guide on quality assurance for statistical processes and outputs.

Developed and assessed gender- and social-disaggregated indicators within national statistical quality frameworks, supporting their use in government planning and SDG monitoring.

Junior Statistical Analyst – Department of Statistical Planning Apr 2019 – Apr 2021

National Institute of Statistics and Censuses, Quito – Ecuador

Coordinated government institutions in the development and review of indicators for Ecuador's National Development Plan, the SDGs, and the Sendai Framework, strengthening alignment between national statistics and international development agendas.

Assessed statistical information needs and availability across 110 surveys, censuses, and administrative data sources to identify data gaps for national planning and monitoring.

Provided technical guidance on socioeconomic indicators derived from national employment, gender, health, and nutrition surveys for government planning and monitoring processes.

Contributed to national gender-statistics initiatives through questionnaire design, methodological development, indicator definition, and statistical quality assurance.

VOLUNTEER WORK

Youth representative

Nov 2020 – Feb 2024

Sustainable Development Solutions Network Andes (SDSN), Quito – Ecuador

Represented Ecuador in the SDSN Andes youth network, coordinating SDG and Paris Agreement initiatives with partners from six Andean countries.

Pollster and Information Analyst

March 2017

Pontifical Catholic University of Ecuador, Quito – Ecuador

Conducted post-disaster data collection on socio-demographic and agricultural conditions following the 2016 Manabí earthquake

Note: Additional training, certifications and code samples are available at camila-aguirre.github.io